

1938, July 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

inclined. Probably you remember when, at the Golden Wedding in 1913 we were all musing over scenes and events on the River Bank and in old Trimbelle someone remarked: "Wouldn't it be nice if we could go back there again!", dear Mother, gently sighing as if revisioning the trials of those days, outweighing the beauties and pleasures--half whispered an exclamation: "Thanks be to God, I'm glad it's over!"

Many a time since I've thought: How beautiful was that little exclamation, how really Christian! For my part, I usually console myself and overcome such "hunger of the heart for days and dreamings never more to be," by thinking of the lonesome changes that were already taking place before we left those scenes of our childhood--scenes of the "burned hills", of the "Big Ravine," of the prairie-fires, etc; and of the "little Poplars", so bright, so beautiful in Spring, and during the day, yet so lonely in the evening; where you, on your way home on a certain evening, (must have been almost night), met a lynx, as you concluded afterwards it must have been, and before you were really scared, must have bluffed it, when, taking it for me, you called out: "Is that you Barney?" Of course, neither of us answered, except, on its part, which was perhaps the best answer we could give under the circumstances, when it leaped into the ticket and let Jimmy Casey pass. It is not hard to reckon the amount of grass that grew, or that didn't grow, under his feet till Jimmy was over the hill and home over big and little hollows. You must have been about 13 at the time. Pardon for such a digression. I'll never get started. Than too, and this belongs to the same digression, I think of how short in comparison with eternal rewards are the pleasures, as well as the trials of this "exile."

After all, what do they either or all amount to, except inasmuch as they buoy us up till the Merciful Father calls us Home, or wean us from inordinate love of the world, and of ourselves--from deceptions so common this side of Heaven. "I walked in the world with the worldly", writes Fr. Ryan in his "Son of the Mystic", indicating something of the vanity of figuring on real peace of soul except in God's service and fostering confidence in Him: "I walked in the world with the worldly, I craved what the world never gave. And I said: In the world each ideal that shines like a star on life's wave is wrecked on the shores of the real and sleeps like a dream in a grave."

Quite in the same spirit too, Moor beautifully tunes in: